

明治大学 商学部 英語 過去問風演習

ビジネス長文一本番想定 (大問1題・25分)

2026年5月26日

高校3年～既卒 (明治大学 商学部志望)

英語 (長文読解・明治商本番レベル)

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Reading Comprehension (25 min, 30 pts) [配点 30 点]

Read the following passage on business strategy and answer the questions.

The "subscription economy" has transformed how companies generate revenue. Rather than selling products outright, businesses increasingly offer ongoing access to services in exchange for recurring monthly or annual payments. (A) This shift represents one of the most significant changes in business models of the past two decades.

Software companies pioneered the model. Adobe, once a seller of expensive software packages, now offers Creative Cloud subscriptions. Microsoft transitioned from one-time Office sales to Microsoft 365. The strategy spread to entertainment (Netflix, Spotify), transportation (car leasing services), and even traditionally physical products like razors (Dollar Shave Club) and meal kits.

(B) For consumers, subscriptions offer lower upfront costs and convenient access to services that update automatically. For companies, the benefits are even greater: predictable recurring revenue, stronger customer relationships, and detailed usage data that informs product development. Investors prize subscription businesses for their stability — a subscription revenue stream is often valued at three to four times the equivalent revenue from one-time sales.

However, the model has critics. (C) Subscription fatigue is real: the average American household subscribes to twelve different services, and many people feel overwhelmed by recurring charges that quietly accumulate on credit cards. Cancellation processes are often deliberately complex, designed to discourage attrition. Regulators in several countries are now considering rules requiring "easy cancellation" features.

The future likely involves a more sustainable balance. Consumers will become more selective, choosing fewer subscriptions of higher value. Companies will need to demonstrate continuous improvement rather than relying on inertia. The subscription economy is here to stay, but its excesses may be tempered.

Notes:

subscription economy — サブスクリプション経済

recurring — 繰り返しの

Reading Comprehension (25 min, 30 pts) — Questions

Q1 1

What does underlined sentence (A) claim about the subscription shift?

- ① It is a minor adjustment in business models.
- ② It is one of the most significant business model changes in the past 20 years.
- ③ It will soon disappear.
- ④ It only affects software companies.

Q2 2

Which company is NOT mentioned as a pioneer of subscription model?

- ① Adobe
- ② Microsoft
- ③ Netflix
- ④ Apple

Q3 3

What benefit do subscriptions offer to consumers according to sentence (B)?

- ① Higher upfront costs
- ② Lower upfront costs and automatic updates
- ③ One-time payment with no recurring charges
- ④ Permanent ownership of products

Q4

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Why do investors value subscription businesses highly?

- ① Because they are always profitable in the first year.
- ② Because subscription revenue streams are valued at 3-4 times equivalent one-time sales due to predictability.
- ③ Because they require no marketing.
- ④ Because they have no competitors.

Q5

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What does 'subscription fatigue' in sentence (C) refer to?

- ① Workers becoming tired from creating subscription services.
- ② Consumers feeling overwhelmed by accumulating recurring charges from many subscriptions.
- ③ Companies running out of subscription ideas.
- ④ Subscription services becoming too cheap.

Q6

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What is the author's likely conclusion about the future?

- ① Subscriptions will completely replace all one-time purchases.
- ② Subscriptions will disappear entirely.
- ③ Subscriptions will continue but with more balance and consumer selectivity.
- ④ Only software will use subscriptions.

解答・解説

問	解答	解説
1	②	【正解】 ② 下線部 (A) は「one of the most significant changes in business models of the past two decades」と直接対応。
2	④	【正解】 ④ 第2段落で言及: Adobe, Microsoft, Netflix, Spotify, Dollar Shave Club。Apple は記述なし。
3	②	【正解】 ② 下線部 (B) 「lower upfront costs and convenient access to services that update automatically」と一致。
4	②	【正解】 ② 第3段落「a subscription revenue stream is often valued at three to four times the equivalent revenue from one-time sales」と一致。
5	②	【正解】 ② 下線部 (C) 「the average American household subscribes to twelve different services, and many people feel overwhelmed」と一致。
6	③	【正解】 ③ 最終段落「The subscription economy is here to stay, but its excesses may be tempered」＋「more sustainable balance」と一致。